Self-Contained Article Template

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Abstract

This document explains how to use the self-contained article template. It shows how to choose build modes, call the helper commands, use the bundled theorem environments, and work with the included table, figure, algorithm, and bibliography support.
Keywords: self-contained template, usage guide, LaTeX template

Contents

1 Quick Start

The template setup is inlined directly after the document class. It configures the page layout, theorem environments, cross-references, figures, tables, algorithms, todo notes, and bibliography support. A typical edit starts by choosing the build mode near the top of this file and then setting the title information:

```
\submissiontrue      % clean output
\usebiblatextrue     % Biber/biblatex workflow

\title{My Document}
\author{Author Name}
\date{\today}

\begin{document}
\maketitle
\templatelistoftodos
\tableofcontents
```

```
...
\printtemplatebibliography
\end{document}
```

Section 2 explains the build-mode toggles, Section 3 shows the helper commands, Section 4 illustrates the theorem and reference setup, and Section 5 shows the figure, table, and algorithm support. For broader LaTeX references, see [1, 2].

2 Build Mode Toggles

The template is controlled by two independent booleans near the top of the preamble: one for review visibility and one for bibliography mode.

Setting	**Effect**	**Typical use**
`\submissiontrue`	Hides todo notes and the todo list	Final or shareable PDF
`\submissionfalse`	Shows todo notes and enables the todo list	Internal review build
`\usebiblatextrue`	Uses Biber through the bibliography helper	Default workflow
`\usebiblatexfalse`	Uses BibTeX through the bibliography helper	BibTeX-only submission flow

Table 1: Core build toggles provided by the template

Use case	Goal	Recommended setting	
		Visibility	Bibliography
Working draft	Keep review notes visible	`\submissionfalse`	`\usebiblatextrue`
	Match a BibTeX-only workflow	`\submissionfalse`	`\usebiblatexfalse`
Final output	Hide review notes	`\submissiontrue`	`\usebiblatextrue`
	Hide notes and use BibTeX	`\submissiontrue`	`\usebiblatexfalse`

Table 2: Example build-mode combinations

In practice, most final builds keep the two default toggles:

```
\submissiontrue
\usebiblatextrue
```

Switch to `\submissionfalse` only when you want to surface inline review annotations.

3 Helper Commands

3.1 Document-Level Helpers

The template exposes several helpers that matter in most documents:

```
\email{person@example.com}
\templatelistoftodos
\printtemplatebibliography
\ccbylicense
\ccbylicense*
```

- `\email{...}` creates a clickable mailto link and is useful in the author block.
- `\templatelistoftodos` prints the todo list only in `draft` mode.
- `\printtemplatebibliography` chooses the bibliography command automatically. It works with both `biblatex` and `natbib`.
- `\ccbylicense` is optional and prints a CC BY 4.0 notice (icon plus linked text) in the first-page footer, as on the title page of this guide; call it right after `\maketitle`. The starred form `\ccbylicense*` repeats the notice in the footer of every page. Renew `\ccbynotice` to adjust the wording, for example to name a copyright holder.

3.2 Todo Commands

Todo helpers are available in every document, but they only render visibly when `\submissionfalse` is set:

```
\Task{Rewrite the introduction}
\TaskPerson{Editor}{Check the notation section}
\TaskDone{Bibliography verified}
\TaskNewPerson{Editor}{Editor}{blue}
\Editor{Rewrite the abstract}
\TaskEditor[highpriority]{Update Figure 2}
```

This design lets one source file serve both as a collaborative draft and as a clean submission build. In `submission` mode, these commands are effectively silent.

3.3 Domain-Specific Math Helpers

The template also bundles a set of graph-reconfiguration macros from the original project. If your article is in that area, they are ready to use:

$$\mathsf{TS}_k(G), \quad \mathsf{TJ}_k(G), \quad \langle I_0, \ldots, I_t \rangle, \quad I \overset{\mathsf{TS}}{\leftrightarrow} J, \quad \mathsf{dist}(u,v), \quad \mathrm{CP}_n.$$

If your document is unrelated to this notation, you can ignore those commands without affecting the rest of the template.

4 Theorems and Cross-References

The template predefines common theorem-style environments such as `theorem`, `lemma`, `corollary`, `proposition`, `definition`, `example`, `remark`, and `problem`. It also loads `cleveref`, so references are printed automatically with the correct labels.

Definition 4.1. A *configured document* is a LaTeX file that uses the inlined setup block and its helper commands instead of duplicating preamble setup elsewhere.

Theorem 4.2. *If a configured document is compiled with* `\submissiontrue`*, then review annotations created by the todo helpers do not appear in the output.*

Proof. The template wraps the todo commands and the todo list helper in conditional checks on the `submission` flag. When that flag is true, the visible note-producing branches are skipped. □

Example 4.3. The sentence "Definition 4.1 and Theorem 4.2 describe the document setup and its clean-output behavior" is generated with ordinary `\cref` commands; the template handles the labels automatically.

Remark 4.4. If you need a new theorem-like environment that is not already bundled, add it in the setup block so the document receives the same numbering and reference behavior.

5 Figures, Tables, and Algorithms

The template setup already loads `graphicx`, `booktabs`, `multirow`, `tikz`, `adjustbox`, and `algorithm2e`. Keep figure assets in `figs/`; the setup sets `\graphicspath{{figs/}}` for you.

5.1 External Images

Typical image commands are available immediately:

```
\includegraphics[width=0.45\textwidth]{example}
\includegraphics[height=3cm,keepaspectratio]{example}
\includegraphics[width=0.45\textwidth,trim=1cm 1cm 1cm 1cm,clip]{example}
```

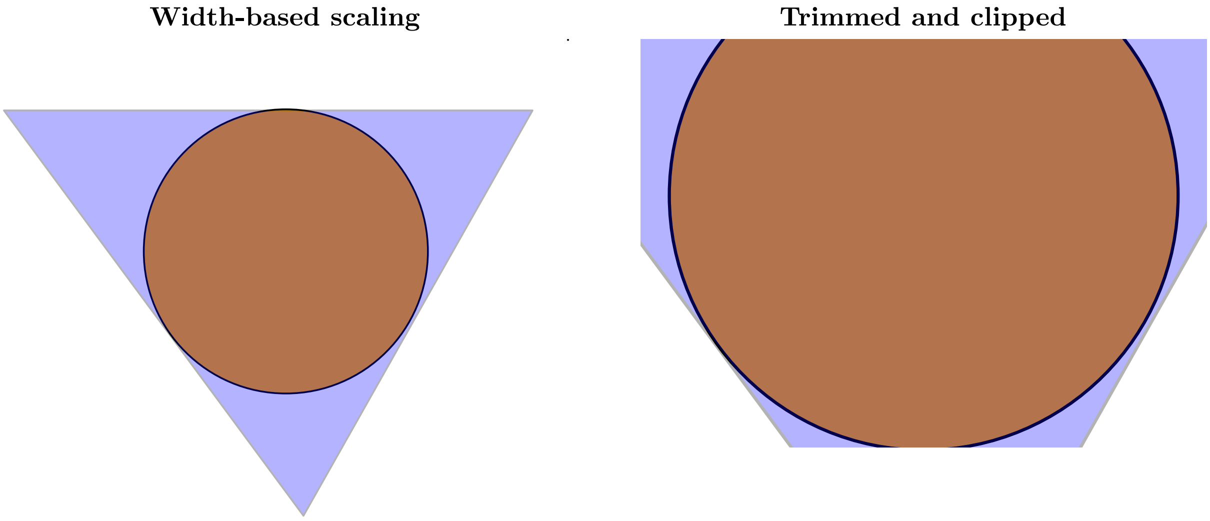

Figure 1: Two common `\includegraphics` patterns using `figs/example.pdf`

5.2 TikZ and Width Control

The template wraps TikZ figures in `adjustbox` so they scale down automatically when they exceed the text width.

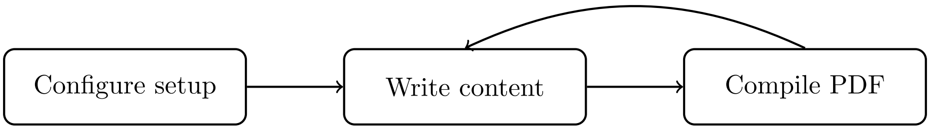

Figure 2: A simple template workflow drawn directly in the source

5.3 Algorithm Example

The algorithm environment is ready for methods, procedures, or reproducibility notes:

Algorithm 1: Choosing a build configuration

Input: A document state and a bibliography preference
Output: Build-mode toggles
Choose `\submissionfalse` if review notes should remain visible; otherwise choose `\submissiontrue`;
Choose `\usebiblatextrue` for the default Biber workflow; otherwise choose `\usebiblatexfalse`;
Compile the document and place the bibliography with `\printtemplatebibliography`;

5.4 Jeff Erickson's Pseudocode Style

The template also bundles the boxed pseudocode environments from Jeff Erickson's `jeffe.sty`, taken from his website (https://jeffe.cs.illinois.edu/); it is the pseudocode style of his textbook *Algorithms*. Pseudocode is written line by line inside a `tabbing`-based box: `\\` starts a new line, `\+` and `\-` change the indentation level, `\mathsc` sets algorithm names in small caps, `\textul` underlines the header line, and `\Comment` produces angle-bracketed comments.

```
\begin{algo} ... \end{algo}         % centered, small, boxed pseudocode
\begin{algobox} ... \end{algobox}   % bare boxed block (jeffe's 'algorithm')
\begin{code} ... \end{code}         % typewriter block, no box
$\mathsc{MergeSort}(A[1..n])$       % algorithm name in small caps
\Comment{a pseudocode comment}
```

```
HANOI(n, src, dst, tmp):
  ⟨⟨Move a stack of n disks from src to dst.⟩⟩
  if n > 0
      HANOI(n − 1, src, tmp, dst)
      move disk n from src to dst
      HANOI(n − 1, tmp, dst, src)
```

The `algo` environment is not a float, so it has no caption or number; use the `algorithm2e` environment shown in Section 5.3 when you need numbered, captioned algorithm floats.

6 Bibliography Workflow

Store bibliography data in `refs.bib`. The template defaults to `biblatex` with Biber, but the same source file can switch to `natbib` with BibTeX by changing the bibliography toggle:

```
\usebiblatextrue
\usebiblatexfalse
```

Use ordinary citation commands in the body, for example [1, 2]. Finish the document with `\printtemplatebibliography` so the template can select the correct bibliography command automatically.

7 Usage Checklist

When you start a new document from this template, the practical checklist is short:

1. Choose the right visibility and bibliography toggles near the top of the preamble.
2. Keep figure assets in `figs/` and bibliography data in `refs.bib`.
3. Place `\templatelistoftodos` near the front matter if you use `draft` mode.
4. Use the bundled theorem, figure, table, and algorithm environments instead of rebuilding the preamble.
5. End the document with `\printtemplatebibliography`.

References

[1] Frank Mittelbach, Michel Goossens, Johannes Braams, David Carlisle, and Chris Rowley. *The LaTeX Companion*. 2nd ed. Addison-Wesley, 2004.

[2] Leslie Lamport. *LaTeX: A Document Preparation System*. 2nd ed. Addison-Wesley, 1994.